

Body odor

Sweat is odorless. It's only when sweat is broken down by the bacteria that live on skin and hair that odor is created. Everyone has body odor and learns how to handle it. Daily washing decreases the amount of bacteria on the skin, and so reduces the likelihood of body odor.

▷ Finding a routine

Showering regularly reduces the number of odor-creating bacteria on the skin.



Dealing with body odor

- Wash every day and as soon as possible after exercising, focusing on the areas you sweat from the most, such as your armpits.
- Use a deodorant or antiperspirant. Deodorants are perfumed substances that disguise the smell of body odor. Antiperspirants reduce the amount you sweat by blocking the pores of the skin.
- Wear fresh clothing, including socks and underwear, every day. Choose clothes made of breathable, natural fibers, such as cotton.

Bad breath

Bad breath (halitosis) has several causes, but one of the most common is food trapped between the teeth. Bacteria in the mouth attach to and break down these food remnants, releasing a smelly gas as they do so. Regular brushing and flossing helps to remove any trapped food, reducing the chances of bad breath and tooth decay.

▷ Bacteria buildup

Switching to a new toothbrush every three months stops the buildup of bacteria.



Solving bad breath

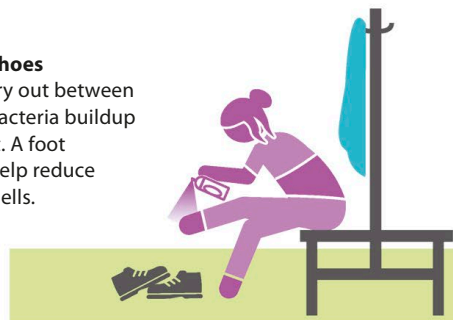
- Brush your teeth and gums for 2–3 minutes at least twice a day. Clean your tongue regularly, too. Floss to remove any food debris trapped between the teeth.
- Drink water with meals to wash out the mouth.
- Avoid smoking. This can make bad breath worse.
- Pay regular visits to a dentist.

Stinky feet

The feet's sweat glands are eccrine glands, which produce sweat that is less likely to be broken down by odor-creating bacteria. However, feet can still start to smell if the sweat is unable to evaporate from the skin—such as when they are cooped up in socks and shoes for long periods. If shoes become damp with sweat, it creates the perfect climate for bacteria to breed and break down the sweat to produce a smelly odor.

▷ Breathable shoes

Shoes need to dry out between wears to avoid bacteria buildup from sweaty feet. A foot deodorant can help reduce and hide foul smells.



Coping with smelly feet

- Thoroughly wash and dry your feet every day.
- Wear fresh socks every day.
- Avoid wearing the same shoes two days in a row. If possible, alternate between pairs of shoes so they have 24 hours to dry out.